ZCAS UNIVERSITY

SMS1281 ACADEMIC WRITING/BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

SECOND SEMESTER SUPPLEMENTARY/DEFERRED EXAM

DATE: 18TH JUNE, 2025

TIME: 09:00-12:00 HOURS

TIME ALLOWED: **WRITING – THREE HOURS**

READING – 5 MINUTES

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: this question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer **THREE (3)** questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks**.
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: Question 1 is compulsory and must be attempted

Question 1

You are a recent graduate from ZACAS University who is applying for jobs and internships in your academic field. A few months ago, you decided to apply for an internship at ZCAS university and this has also taken longer to receive any response from the office of the registrar of the institution. As a former student who studied at the same institution, you were hopeful that your application for an internship was going to be considered. Based on this background, you decided to write a letter to ZCAS University to follow up on your application.

Task

A. Using a Block format, write a follow-up letter to ZCAS University regarding your internship (30 marks)

B. As a professional with a background in business communication what are some of the common mistakes to avoid when writing a follow-up letter? (10 marks)

(Total 40 marks)

SECTION B: Attempt any THREE questions in this section

Question 2

Case study

You are a communications professional working for a non-profit organization that advocates for environmental protection in rural districts in Zambia. Your organization is planning to launch a new campaign that targets a multinational corporation that has a history of environmental violations. As part of the campaign, you have been tasked with creating a social media post that calls out the corporation and encourages people to take action. However, you are concerned about the potential ethical implications of the post.

Task

A. Analyse how the ten ethical principles in communication apply to the case study example given, which needs to be taken into account when creating a social media post that calls out a corporation for communication ethical violations. **(20 marks)**

Question 3

You are a consultant hired by a manufacturing company to help them implement various emerging trends in communication as new technology that will increase production efficiency and reduce communication problems experienced in modern business environments. However, the implementation process is met with resistance from some employees who are concerned about job security and the impact on their workload. The CEO has asked you to create a communication plan that addresses these concerns and persuades employees to support the implementation on various emerging trends in business communication.

Task

Using a case study, compare and contrast persuasive and argumentative writing. In your essay, include specific examples of how each style can promote the implementation of emerging trends in business communication driven by new technologies, highlighting their potential benefits. **(use paragraphs to answer this question and not a table)**

Question 4

Discuss the relevance of literature search and show the ten principles of literature search apply to academic assignment writing **(20 marks)**

Question 5

Write brief notes on the following

A. How to write an academic paragraph (5 Marks)

B. How to write an introduction of an academic paper (5 Marks)

C. How to write a conclusion of an academic paper (5 marks)

D. Narrative writing (5 Marks)

(Total 20 marks)

END OF THE EXAMINATION